

Discussant Comments

Korea in Global Political Economy and Public Opinion (APSA 2026)

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From Threat to Need (Kim, Kweon, Liu, Xu)

- The **childcare vs. eldercare distinction**: the two treatment arms already split along this line, and the age-heterogeneity results hint at a generational-beneficiary story
- why is care work a most-likely-to-succeed case for benefit framing?: can make the null-to-negative result more striking
- egocentric vs. sociotropic framing: a better contextualization of the age-driven reversal (esp. for IPE audiences)
- Conjoint results: maybe more than the appendix? (wrt. H_2 & H_3)
- Job Competition item is worded generally despite sector-specific priming — worth flagging as evidence of generalized economic-threat perception
- Japan: Consider a mediation or subgroup analysis to back up the clean co-movement pattern (Fig. 4)

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Democratic Integration of Migrants from Autocracy (Gilligan, Son)

- Define “**democratic integration**” more precisely in the theory section and tie v_i and $s(n_i)$ to social capital vs. democratic attitudes literature(s).
- Re-frame Findings 3–4 vs. 5–9 through a “portability” lens: social capital transfers across regimes, democratic attitudes/norms do not.
- Situate the “Korean experiment” design as a methodological contribution to natural experiments **in general**.
- Draw on system justification / identity-protective cognition to deepen the account of Findings 8–9 (implicit pro-DPRK bias)
- Extend the mechanism to **domestic regime transitions** (e.g., post-communist Europe) in the conclusion to widen the paper’s claim.

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